The SMART Study

INVITATION FOR PARENTS AND CARERS

# Will your family help find out what's best for children and phones?

Nobody knows yet the best age for a first smartphone, or how best to set one up. **[School name]** is helping to find out, as one of around 80 primary schools in the SMART Study. It runs from **September 2027** to **September 2028**, for children in **Years 3 to 5**, and we'd love your family to take part.

## Will you take part?

Say yes by **[date]**: scan the QR code or go to **[web address]**. It takes about 5 minutes.

[QR code]

## What taking part involves for your family

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|---|---|
| **Summer term 2027** | Say yes. That's all until the study starts in September 2027. |
| **Autumn term 2027** | Your child does the first of two short reading and maths assessments (in the PIRA and PUMA format many schools already use) at school. There's nothing to prepare. |
| **Three times** | A short online survey about how your family is getting on (about **[10] minutes**), in [December 2027, April 2028 and September 2028]. |
| **Summer term 2028** | Your child does the second assessment. The study ends in September 2028. |

**Two groups, chosen by chance.** To make it a fair test, schools are split into two groups by chance. In one, families follow a simple plan until September 2028: if their child has no smartphone, they wait; if they have one, they set it up with a short list of apps and share a screen time screenshot once a month, with our step-by-step help. In the other, families carry on as usual. Everyone does the same surveys and assessments.

## What you get, whichever group you're in

**A [£X] voucher**
After each survey you fill in.

**Fun things for your child**
Motivational videos, comic books and a newsletter.

**What we find**
A summary of what your family helped to find out.

**Taking part is your choice. You can stop at any time, without giving a reason.**

Questions? Ask [staff name] at school, or email smartphonestudy@public.io.

Run by IFF Research, PUBLIC and the University of Cambridge for the Department for Education.